

Greek Chicken Gyro Bowls

Status: Stage 1 Draft

Weekly folder: `weekly-plans/2026/week-28/`

Category: Chicken

Source or inspiration: Next-week family menu idea

Date added: 2026-07-04

Planning Summary

- Servings: 4
- Estimated prep time: 30 minutes, plus optional marinade time
- Estimated cook time: 25 minutes
- Protein: Chicken thighs
- Cuisine or flavor direction: Greek-inspired lemon oregano chicken, rice bowls, fresh toppings, tzatziki
- Best day to cook: Thursday
- Perishability notes: Uses romaine, cucumber, tomato, yogurt, and chicken. Keep toppings fresh and assemble day-of.

Equipment

- Large skillet or grill pan
- Medium saucepan with lid
- Mixing bowls
- Box grater or microplane
- Cutting board and knife

Ingredients

Assume nothing is on hand. Include quantities for everything used.

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
2 lb	Boneless skinless chicken thighs	Trimmed	Chicken breast	Main protein
3 tbsp	Olive oil	Extra-virgin or regular	Avocado oil	Marinade
2 tbsp	Lemon juice	Fresh	Bottled lemon juice	Marinade
3 cloves	Garlic	Fresh minced	1 tsp garlic powder	Marinade
2 tsp	Dried oregano	Greek oregano preferred	Italian oregano	Marinade
1 tsp	Smoked paprika	Smoked	Sweet paprika	Marinade
1/2 tsp	Ground cumin	Ground	Skip if desired	Marinade
1 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Marinade
1/2 tsp	Black pepper	Freshly ground	Ground black pepper	Marinade
1 1/2 cups	Jasmine rice	Dry	Long-grain white rice	Bowl base

Quantity	Ingredient	Preferred version/type	Acceptable alternatives	Notes
2 1/4 cups	Water	Cold	Low-sodium chicken broth	Rice
1/2 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Rice
2 hearts	Romaine lettuce	Chopped	Green leaf lettuce	Bowl topping
1 pint	Grape tomatoes	Halved	Diced tomatoes	Bowl topping
1 large	English cucumber	Diced	2 Persian cucumbers	Bowl topping
1/2 cup	Pickled red onion	Homemade quick pickle	Store-bought	Bowl topping
1/2	Red onion	Thinly sliced	Shallot	Quick pickle
1/2 cup	Red wine vinegar	Red wine vinegar	White vinegar	Quick pickle
1 tsp	Sugar	Granulated	Honey	Quick pickle
1/2 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Quick pickle
1 1/2 cups	Plain Greek yogurt	Full-fat or 2 percent	Regular plain yogurt, strained	Tzatziki
1/2 large	English cucumber	Grated and squeezed dry	Persian cucumber	Tzatziki
1 tbsp	Lemon juice	Fresh	Bottled lemon juice	Tzatziki
1 clove	Garlic	Fresh grated	1/4 tsp garlic powder	Tzatziki
1 tbsp	Fresh dill	Chopped	1 tsp dried dill	Tzatziki
1 tbsp	Olive oil	Extra-virgin	Skip if desired	Tzatziki
1/4 tsp	Kosher salt	Kosher	Fine sea salt	Tzatziki

Basic Instructions

1. Marinate chicken with olive oil, lemon juice, garlic, oregano, smoked paprika, cumin, salt, and pepper for 20 minutes or up to 8 hours.
2. Start rice: rinse jasmine rice, then simmer with water and salt for 15 minutes. Rest covered 10 minutes.
3. Make quick pickled onions by combining sliced red onion, vinegar, sugar, and salt. Let sit at least 20 minutes.
4. Make tzatziki by mixing Greek yogurt, squeezed cucumber, lemon juice, garlic, dill, olive oil, and salt.
5. Cook chicken in a skillet or grill pan over medium-high heat for 5 to 7 minutes per side, until browned and 165 degrees F inside. Rest 5 minutes, then slice.
6. Build bowls with rice, chicken, romaine, tomato, cucumber, pickled onion, and tzatziki.

Notes

- What might need testing: Whether rice or pita would be preferred next time.
- Possible substitutions: Add feta if the family wants a saltier bowl.
- Prep-ahead ideas: Make tzatziki and pickled onion Wednesday night. Chop romaine day-of.
- Family preference concerns: Keep components separate for customizable bowls.

Review Link

Review file: